The heart is divided into four chambers. Two upper chambers are called atria or auricles (Singular-atrium). Two lower chambers are called ventricles. The upper and lower chambers of the heart are separated by a muscular wall or tissue known as the auriculo-ventricular septum of the heart. The right side of the heart receives deoxygenated blood from various parts of the body and pumps it to the lungs for oxygenation. The left side of the heart receives oxygenated blood from the lungs and pumps it into different parts of the body.

2 Blood vessels

Blood vessels consist of arteries, veins and capillaries. Arteries carry oxygenated blood (except pulmonary artery which carries deoxygenated blood from the heart) and veins carry deoxygenated blood (except pulmonary vein which carries oxygenated blood to the heart).

Capillaries are thin blood vessels which connect the arteries and veins. They help in exchange of materials between circulatory system and body tissue.

3 Blood

Blood transports nutrients, oxygen, wastes and hormones. The volume of blood in human adults is 4-5 litres. It regulates water level and the body temperature. Blood is pumped through out the body by the heart. It takes oxygen to tissues and cells and finally reaches the lungs to take oxygen again.



Activity 2

Locate your pulse points either on wrist or neck. Place your right index and middle finger on the palm side of your left wrist. On the neck the pulse point is located beneath the ear and jaw bone. Count the number of beats for 15 seconds. Multiply this by four (15 * 4 = 60). This shows how many times the heart beats in one minute.



Do you know?

There are some animals like lobsters and crabs that have blue blood. Cockroach has colourless or white blood.



IV. Excretory System

Excretory system removes the waste products from the body. It also regulates water and electrolyte balance. Kidneys, lungs, liver and skin together function as excretory organs. Excretory system consists of the following.

1. Kidneys
2. Ureters
3. Urinary bladder

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